Mariano Marcos State University
THE Impact Rankings 2027 · SDG 15 Life on Land

STORYBOARD · INDICATOR

15.3.2

Monitoring IUCN and other conservation species (policy)

DRAFT

Evidence year **2025**

Data submission due **9 Nov 2026**

2 × 2025 evidence · 1 × continuing · 1 × to be produced

15 LIFE ON LAND

THE ASKS

Have a policy to ensure that IUCN Red List species and national conservation list species with habitats in areas affected by university operations are identified, monitored and protected.

MMSU'S COMMITMENT

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

STORYLINE

The raw material is here: threatened-plant surveys and a regional programme. The policy and species register are not. Draft.

COMPENDIUM NOTE · DRAFT

DRAFT. THE asks for a policy to identify, monitor and protect IUCN Red List and national-list species in areas affected by university operations. This section shows the IFP Program, adopted by RDC Region 1, conserving locally threatened plants. The 2003 classification applied IUCN criteria locally; it is not the IUCN Red List. Attach the RDC resolution and any MMSU policy or species register before submitting.

THE FILMSTRIP · 4 FRAMES



AT A GLANCE

77
plants validated vanishing

45 + 32
endangered + vulnerable

1st
RDC Region 1 R&D item

FRAME · POLICY AND REGISTER

MMSU policy to identify, monitor and protect IUCN Red List and national-list species, with a species register

FRAME TO BE PRODUCED

MMSU policy to identify, monitor and protect IUCN Red List and national-list species, with a species register

1 **WHY IT IS MISSING**

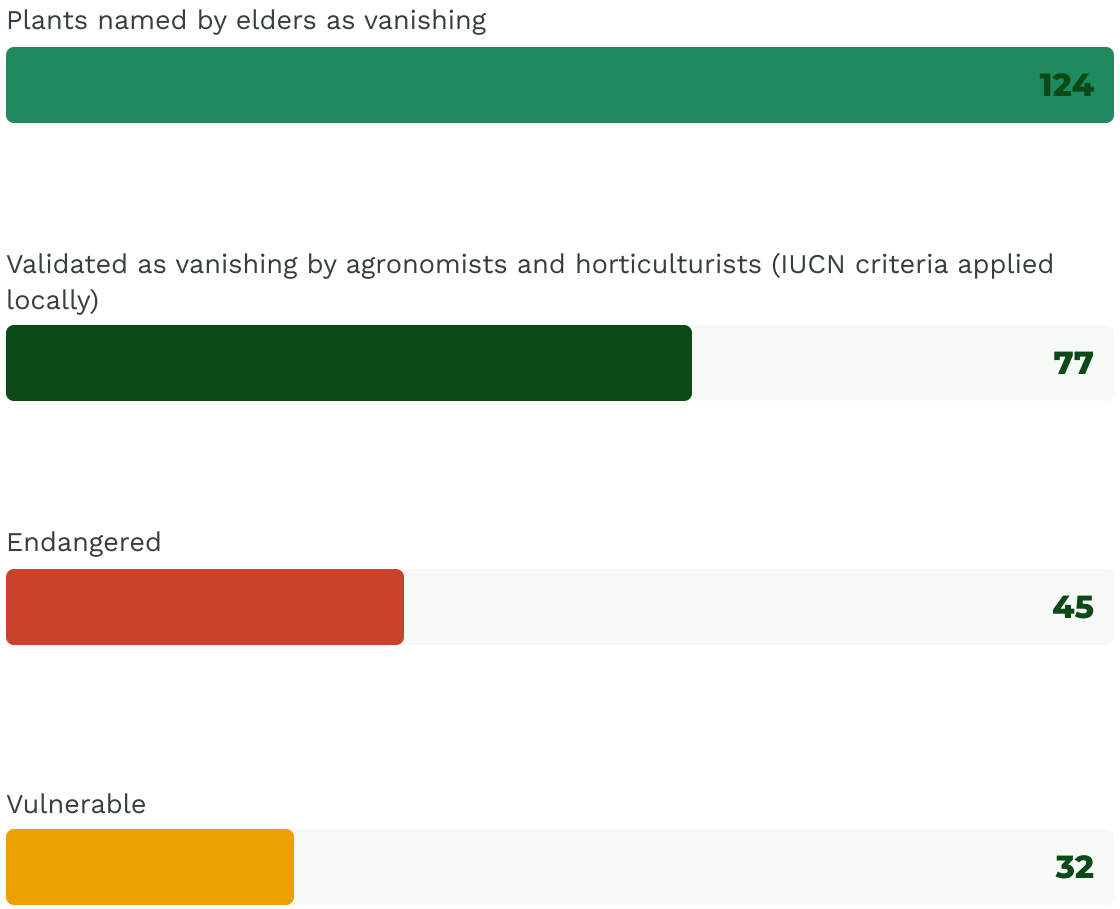
DRAFT. THE asks for a policy to identify, monitor and protect IUCN Red List and national-list species in areas affected by university operations. This section shows the IFP Program, adopted by RDC Region 1, conserving locally threatened plants. The 2003 classification applied IUCN criteria locally; it is not the IUCN Red List. Attach the RDC resolution and any MMSU policy or species register before submitting.

2 **WHAT IT MUST SHOW**

Attach the RDC Region 1 resolution and any register of species on the forest reserves.

Sources: none yet

2003 survey of Laoag City, Batac, Pasuquin, San Nicolas and Dingras



2003 AND 2011 · IDENTIFYING THE PLANTS AT RISK PART 1 OF 2

From Vanishing Plants: How MMSU Identified Threatened Indigenous Food Plants

1. **2003 · THE SURVEY**
   MMSU researchers (Dr. Miriam Pascua, Ms. Menisa Antonio, Dr. Dionisio Bucao) documented plants elders saw as vanishing; 77 of 124 were validated, among them sugod-sugod (Momordica cochinchinensis), kapas-kapas and bignay (Antidesma bunius).
2. **2011 · THE STUDY**
   SEARCA published “Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte”: 46 plants from 27 families in seven upland and remote municipalities, with identity, uses and locations.
3. **THE CAVEAT**
   The 2003 classification applied IUCN criteria locally; it is not the IUCN Red List.

77	46	27
validated vanishing	IFPs in 7 towns	plant families

Source: The Philippine Star, “MMSU researchers identify vanishing plant species,” 14 September 2003 · Antonio, M. A., Utrera, R. T., Agustin, E. O., Jamias, D. L., Badar, A. J. and Pascua, M. E. (2011), “Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte, Philippines,” SEARCA Agriculture and Development Discussion Paper No. 2011-2, 61 pp. · MMSU Research Directorate, “MMSU research on indigenous food plants wins best paper at SUC-ACAP 2025 Conference,” 29 August 2025 *+3 more on the submission panel*



Farmers and local officials trained on alukon (himbabao) propagation, Brgy. 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

2025 · CONSERVING AND MONITORING PART 2 OF 2

To Regional Policy: The IFP Program Conserves and Monitors the Plants

1. **THE PROGRAM**
   The IFP Program, led by Dr. Menisa A. Antonio of the Research Directorate, documents IFP species and protects them through a botanical garden (ex situ), a himbabao (alukon) genebank, circa situ cultivation of wild yams, and community foodscapes; it is advancing omics-based molecular characterization.
2. **IN 2025**
   Trained 64 farmers and officials in Sarrat on alukon propagation (2 May), extended seedbanks and foodscapes to new Vintar partner barangays (Oct), and won Best Paper at the SUC-ACAP 2025 Biennial Conference.
3. **REGIONAL POLICY**
   The first R&D initiative adopted by the Regional Development Council of Region 1, providing input for policy advocacy on conserving and using these species; propagation continues (PNA, 6 Jun 2026).

64
farmers trained

1st
RDC Region 1 R&D initiative

Source: The Philippine Star, “MMSU researchers identify vanishing plant species,” 14 September 2003 · Antonio, M. A., Utrera, R. T., Agustin, E. O., Jamias, D. L., Badar, A. J. and Pascua, M. E. (2011), “Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte, Philippines,” SEARCA Agriculture and Development Discussion Paper No. 2011-2, 61 pp. · MMSU Research Directorate, “MMSU research on indigenous food plants wins best paper at SUC-ACAP 2025 Conference,” 29 August 2025 *+3 more on the submission panel*



Capture: Philippine News Agency post of 6 June 2026 on indigenous food plants propagated at the MMSU NRCMC botanical garden (photos: Leilanie Adriano, PNA).



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

6 JUN 2026 · MMSU NATURAL RESOURCES CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT CENTER, BATAC

Indigenous Food Plants Propagated at the MMSU Botanical Garden Are Shared with Schools and Communities

Continuing implementation · Philippine News Agency, 6 June 2026

1. **THE REPORT**
   The Philippine News Agency reported that sugod-sugod, alokon, buga and karot are being propagated at the NRCMC botanical garden.

2. **THE SHARING**
   Planting materials go to schools and community stakeholders for food gardens, to boost food security and give farmers an additional income source.

3. **THE LINK**
   The garden is the ex situ arm of the IFP Program, which in 2025 extended community foodscapes and seedbanks to new partner barangays.

LENS FOR 15.3.2

Continuing: the ex situ collection of threatened indigenous food plants is still maintained and shared.

Source: Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026

RECOMMENDED ANSWER ON THE THE FORM

Draft: attach policy and register first

DRAFT

DRAFT COMMENT

697 / 1,000 characters

DRAFT. MMSU identifies, conserves and monitors locally threatened plants through its Indigenous Food Plants Program: a 2003 survey validated 77 vanishing plants (45 endangered, 32 vulnerable) using IUCN criteria applied locally; a 2011 SEARCA study documented 46 indigenous food plants from 27 families; the program conserves them in a botanical garden, an alukon genebank and community foodscapes, and was adopted as the first R&D initiative of the RDC of Region 1. Note: this is a local classification, not the IUCN Red List. Attach the RDC resolution and any species register. research.mmsu.edu.ph/news/details/mmsu-research-on-indigenous-food-plants-wins-best-paper-at-suc-acap-2025-conference

POLICY YEARS (THE FORM ASKS FOR BOTH)

Created (yyyy)
Not stated

Reviewed (yyyy)
Not stated

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- Attach the RDC Region 1 resolution and any MMSU policy or species register.
- Do not describe the 2003 classification as the IUCN Red List.
- Confirm the 2027 data year with THE before upload.
- Upload one file per indicator (this storyboard is built for that). THE rejects evidence that is mainly a list of links.

EVIDENCE LINKS (6)

1. The Philippine Star, “MMSU researchers identify vanishing plant species,” 14 September 2003
   https://philstar.com/business/2003/09/14/220344/mmsu-researchers-identify-vanishing-plant-species
2. Antonio, M. A., Utrera, R. T., Agustin, E. O., Jamias, D. L., Badar, A. J. and Pascua, M. E. (2011), “Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte, Philippines,” SEARCA Agriculture and Development Discussion Paper No. 2011-2, 61 pp.
   https://www.searca.org/pubs/discussion-papers?pid=130
3. MMSU Research Directorate, “MMSU research on indigenous food plants wins best paper at SUC-ACAP 2025 Conference,” 29 August 2025
   https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/news/details/mmsu-research-on-indigenous-food-plants-wins-best-paper-at-suc-acap-2025-conference
4. MMSU News, “MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation,” 9 May 2025
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-trains-sarrat-farmers-on-alukon-propagation
5. MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025
   https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
6. Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026
   https://www.facebook.com/pnagovph/posts/1411199747723142/